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OCT 11 2021
State Board of
Behavioral Health Licensure

**GLORIA AL ESMAEL, LPC,
LICENSE NO. 4457**
Respondent.

CONSENT ORDER

COMES NOW the State of Oklahoma, ex rel, the State Board of Behavioral Health
 Licensure (“the Board”) by and through its attorney, Liz Stevens, Assistant Attorney General, and
 Gloria Al Esmael (“Respondent”), and hereby enter into this Consent Order, pursuant to
 59 O.S. §1912(A) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act, 86:10-29-3(b)(2)(C) of the
 Oklahoma Administrative Code, and 75 O.S. §309(E) of the Administrative Procedures Act. For
 the purposes of this Consent Order, the following facts are hereby stipulated to by the parties and
 adopted by the Board:

STIPULATION OF FACTS

1. Respondent is a Licensed Professional Counselor in the State of Oklahoma, holding License Number 4457 and was licensed on or about October 15, 2010.
2. On or about June 8, 2017, the Board received a Request for Inquiry (“RFI”) alleging Respondent engaged in an intimate relationship with a former client fewer than five (5) years after the counseling relationship ended.

3. On or about June 26, 2019, the Board received another Request for Inquiry ("RFI") alleging Respondent engaged in an intimate relationship with a former client fewer than five (5) years after the counseling relationship ended.

4. Regarding the 17-LPC-54 RFI, Respondent was providing therapeutic services at Lawton Correctional Facility. After he was released, the client moved in with her and they began a "long term" relationship.

5. Regarding the 19-LPC-43 RFI, Respondent provided therapeutic services to a client at Catalyst Behavioral Services for a period of time ending in February 2019. Respondent admitted to having several encounters with the client after the therapeutic relationship ended, including going to dinner, church, and the gym with him. Respondent also admitted to going to the client's house and kissing him.

6. In order to resolve all issues raised in the Request for Inquiry filed in this matter, the parties agree to the below Agreed Conclusions of Law and Agreed Order.

AGREED CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

1. The Board has jurisdiction over this matter and Respondent pursuant to 59 O.S. §1905(B)(4) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act.

2. Pursuant to 59 O.S. §1912(A)(5) of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act, the Board has the authority to deny, revoke, suspend, or place on probation any license if that license holder has engaged in unprofessional conduct.

3. Pursuant to 59 O.S. §1913.1(B), the Board has the authority to impose an administrative penalty not to exceed ten thousand dollars (\$10,000) on any person who is determined to have violated any provision of the Licensed Professional Counselors Act or any rule promulgated, or

order issued pursuant thereto.

4. Respondent agrees that she did not comply with the Licensed Professional Counselor Act nor the Oklahoma Administrative Code. Respondent violated the following:

86:10-3-3. Client welfare

(f) **Interaction with former clients.** LPCs shall not knowingly enter into a close personal relationship, or engage in any business or financial dealings with a former client for five (5) years after the termination of the counseling relationship. LPCs shall not engage in any activity that is or may be sexual in nature, as defined by the Board, with a former client after the termination of the counseling relationship. Sexual conduct with former clients is prohibited. LPCs shall not exploit or obtain an advantage over a former client by the use of information or trust gained during the counseling relationship.

AGREED ORDER

The Board and Respondent agree to the following Order:

1. Respondent shall surrender her LPC license.
2. Respondent shall not reapply for a LPC license for a for a period of at least two (2) years.
3. Respondent understands and agrees that should any future instances be brought to the attention of the Board in which Respondent has violated the Licensed Professional Counselor Act or the Oklahoma Administrative Code, the Board reserves the right to prosecute such violations and to consider this Consent Order as a factor in the determination of any sanctions and penalties, if any, should the Board determine that any violation has occurred.

4. Failure to comply with any of the terms of this Order may result in further disciplinary action against Respondent, including, but not limited to, the suspension or revocation of Respondent's license.

PUBLIC RECORD

Respondent acknowledges that once adopted by the Board, this Consent Order and all associated documentation becomes a matter of public record, unless otherwise excluded by law.

ACCEPTANCE BY BOARD

This Consent Order will not be submitted for Board consideration until it has been agreed to and executed by Respondent. The Consent Order shall not become effective until it has been approved by a majority of the Board and endorsed by a representative of the Board.

It is hereby agreed between the parties that this Consent Order shall be presented to the Board with a recommendation of approval from the Board at the Board Meeting scheduled for October 8, 2021. Respondent understands that the Board is free to accept or reject this Consent Order and, if rejected by the Board, a formal disciplinary hearing on the Complaint against Respondent may be held.

If the Consent Order is not accepted by the Board, it shall be regarded as null and void. Admissions by Respondent in the Consent Order will not be regarded as evidence against her at the subsequent disciplinary hearing. Respondent will be free to defend herself and no inferences will be made from her willingness to have entered into this agreement. It is agreed that neither the presentation of the Consent Order nor the Board's consideration of the Consent Order will be deemed to have unfairly or illegally prejudiced the Board or its individual members and therefore

will not be grounds for precluding the Board or any individual Board member from further participation in proceedings related to the matters set forth in this Consent Order.

VOLUNTARY WAIVER OF RIGHTS

Respondent is fully aware of her rights to contest the allegations pending against her. Respondent acknowledges these rights include: representation by an attorney at her own expense; the right to a public hearing on any charges or allegations filed; the right to confront and cross-examine witnesses called to testify against her; the right to present evidence on her own behalf; the right to compulsory process to secure attendance of such witnesses; the right to testify on her own behalf; the right to receive written findings of fact and conclusions of law supporting the decision on the merits of the Complaint and the right to obtain judicial review of the Board's decision. Respondent in exchange for the Board's acceptance of this Consent Order voluntarily waives all of these rights.

COMPLETE AGREEMENT

This Consent Order consists of six (6) pages and embodies the entire agreement between the Board and Respondent. It may not be altered and modified without the express consent of the parties.


AMY BARNETT, LPC CC Board Member

Dated this 28 day of September, 2021.

IT IS SO ORDERED.

STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH LICENSURE

By: Dr. Kelly Collins, LPC
BOARD MEMBER

Dated this 8th day of Oct, 2021.

I have read the entirety of this Consent Order. I understand that by its terms I waive certain rights accorded me under Oklahoma law. I agree to this Consent Order.

Gloria Al Esmal Dated this 15 day of Sept., 2021.
Gloria Al Esmal, Respondent

CERTIFICATION OF BOARD ATTORNEY

I believe this Consent Order to be in the best interests of the State Board of Behavioral Health Licensure and the State of Oklahoma for the violations as outlined in the foregoing Consent Order.

Liz Stevens
LIZ STEVENS, OBA NO. 34185
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Dated this 28 day of September, 2021.

ATTORNEY FOR THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA
STATE BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH